JAMES RICHARDSON

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a Staff Engineer with 14 years of hands-on experience building and maintaining large-scale systems that handle millions of transactions daily. I've spent the last decade focused on backend infrastructure, distributed systems, and leading technical initiatives across cross-functional teams. I enjoy solving complex architectural problems and mentoring junior engineers through difficult projects. Outside of work, I'm obsessed with cycling and competing in local races around Yorkshire.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Staff Engineer

TechVault Solutions

techvault.io

Leeds, United Kingdom

September 2019 - Present

Designed and implemented a microservices migration strategy that reduced deployment times from 45 minutes to 8 minutes across 12 services serving 2 million daily active users.

Led the establishment of observability standards using Prometheus and Grafana, resulting in 60 percent reduction in mean time to resolution for production incidents.

Architected a multi-region failover system that achieved 99.99 percent uptime across data centers in London and Frankfurt, handling 50,000 requests per second during peak load.

Mentored four junior engineers through six-month rotation programs, three of whom were promoted to mid-level positions within 18 months.

Principal Engineer

DataStream Technologies

datastream.co

Manchester, United Kingdom

January 2019 - August 2021

Developed a real-time data processing pipeline using Apache Kafka and Apache Spark that ingested and processed 500 GB of data daily from multiple external sources.

Refactored legacy payment processing system written in Java, reducing database query times by 70 percent through intelligent indexing and query optimization.

Implemented comprehensive API rate limiting and caching strategies that improved customer-facing endpoint response times from 800ms to 120ms.

Established continuous integration and continuous deployment pipelines that automated testing for 45 microservices and reduced manual deployment overhead by 80 percent.

Software Engineer

CyberGuard Security

cyberguard.net

Leeds, United Kingdom

June 2010 - December 2018

Built and maintained authentication and authorization systems protecting customer data across three separate security products used by Fortune 500 companies.

Developed distributed log aggregation system that indexed 10 billion events per day, enabling security teams to detect threats within seconds rather than hours.

Migrated legacy monolithic application to event-driven architecture, improving system reliability and enabling the product team to ship features 40 percent faster.

Collaborated with security and compliance teams to implement encryption standards and audit logging mechanisms required for SOC 2 Type II certification.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Manchester

Manchester, United Kingdom

Graduated: June 2010

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Go, Python, Java, SQL, Bash

Distributed Systems: Kafka, RabbitMQ, gRPC, Protocol Buffers

Cloud Platforms: AWS, Google Cloud Platform, Azure

Containerization: Docker, container orchestration

Infrastructure as Code: Kubernetes, Terraform, ArgoCD

Databases: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Elasticsearch, Redis

Monitoring and Logging: Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack, Datadog

Version Control: Git, GitHub, GitLab